StartNet.

Brand *Book*

Every talent, a founder. The identity as it is built: one name, one red point, one network of dots.

EDITION	VERSION	PRIMARY COLOUR	STATUS
First	1.0 · Oct 2026	SNX Red #EF4444	For sign-off

Contents

01 — BRAND

06 Mission and promise
07 The brand idea
08 What we value
09 Who we speak to
10 Brand architecture and naming
11 Voice and tone
12 Writing rules
13 Messaging and boilerplate

02 — LOGO

15 The lockup
16 Construction and the full stop
17 Clear space and minimum size
18 Colour versions
19 Brand lockups
20 Monogram and app icons
21 Co-branding
22 Misuse

03 — COLOUR

24 Primary colour: SNX Red
25 How the palette is derived
26 Secondary palette
27 Tertiary palette
28 Neutrals and grounds
29 Brand family accents
30 Functional palette
31 Tonal ramps
32 Gradients and texture
33 Proportion and contrast

04 — TYPE & ELEMENT

35 The type pairing
36 Tamil typography
37 Type scale and rules
38 The full stop system
39 Pulli grid and network
40 Iconography
41 Photography
42 Layout and cover architecture

05 — APPLICATIONS

44 Stationery
45 Business card and event badge
46 Event signage
47 Deck template
48 Social posts
49 Certificates
50 Merchandise
51 Website and email

BACK MATTER

52 Governance and sign-off

00.1

How to use this book

WHAT THIS IS

The single source for how StartNet looks and sounds. Where this book and an older file disagree, this book is correct.

It builds on the brand system in the StartNet Website Books (Book 3, Brand Identity) and adopts SNX Red as the primary colour.

WHAT IT GOVERNS

Anything carrying the name: the website, StartNet X, decks, print, events, signage, social, merchandise and partner material.

It covers all four talent brands: Research, Vibe, Connect and Women. Product interface tokens inherit from here.

WHEN IT IS SILENT

Follow the nearest example in the book, and send the work to brand review before it ships.

A new pattern used twice becomes a rule. Write it in here rather than repeating the judgement.

OWNER	REVIEW CYCLE	ASSET LIBRARY	SOURCE BOOKS
Brand, StartNet	**Every two quarters**	**startnet.in/media**	**Website Books 1–4**

00.2

What this edition *decides*

The brand system in Book 3 stays: the promise, the red full stop, the pulli grid, Inter and the four brand accents. This edition makes one change and two proposals.



Book 3 red
#E5322D · retired

→



SNX Red
#EF4444 · primary

01 **Primary moves to SNX Red #EF4444.**
Taken from the SNX One deck. A touch lighter than #E5322D, so it stays bright on screens, stands and print.

02 **Secondary: Ink #0C1719.**
The red's complement taken almost to black. It carries type, covers and every dark surface.

03 **Tertiary: Marigold #FBA62A and Lagoon #117780.**
One warm, one cool, both measured off the red. Highlights, data and campaigns only.

04 **Status: proposal.**
The SNX One deck is an inspiration document. Pages 24–33 are ready to adopt once StartNet signs off on page 52.

01 Brand

MISSION AND PROMISE THE BRAND IDEA WHAT WE VALUE WHO WE SPEAK TO ARCHITECTURE VOICE WRITING MESSAGING

01.1

Mission and promise

PROMISE

Every talent, a founder.

The full stop is deliberate: a statement, not a hope. It is where a founder’s story turns from “maybe” into “done”: the company registered, the pilot signed, the first ₹ raised.

POSITIONING

Tamil Nadu’s founder-making network

It replaces “India’s first integrated startup ecosystem platform”.

MISSION

We go to campuses, labs, workplaces and districts, and help people with the talent to build turn it into companies.

As written on startnet.in.

GOAL · MISSION 1 LAKH

1,00,000 founders nurtured in Tamil Nadu by March 2031

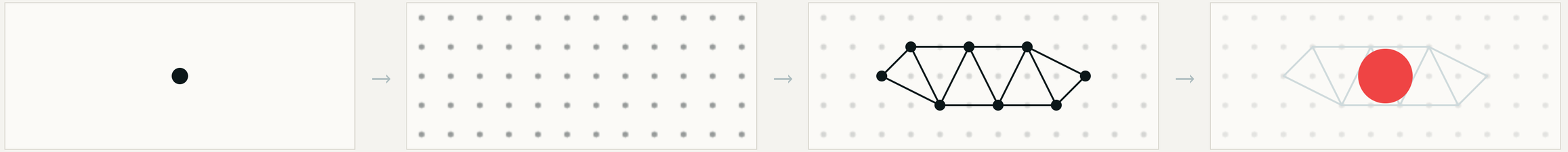
Counted in a public, quarterly Founder Ledger. “Nurtured” means a StartNet X profile plus at least two meaningful programme touchpoints (L2 and above). A planning target, not a result.

TARGET

01.2

The brand *idea*

One device carries the promise. A dot is a person; dots on a kolam grid become a network; the network resolves into one decisive point: the red full stop.



01 Dot

One talent: a student, a scholar, a professional, a woman founder.

APPEARS IN Bullets, list markers, the Ledger counter, avatar placeholders

02 Grid

The *pulli* grid under the Tamil kolam: an ordered field of possibility.

APPEARS IN Illustration grids, night-surface texture, icon construction

03 Network

Dots joined by lines, as a kolam joins *pulli*: StartNet's connective role.

APPEARS IN Diagrams, the network graph, the district map, Vibathon season art

04 Full stop

The outcome: a founder. The one red dot on any composition.

APPEARS IN The logo, headline endings, the "landing" motion, the Mission 1 Lakh meter

VISUAL CONCEPT · CALM PAGE, DECISIVE POINT

MODE	USED FOR	CHARACTER
Day · default	Masterbrand, brand hubs, programmes, partners, media	Calm, editorial, photography-led
Night	Insights, Founder Ledger, Mission 1 Lakh, footer	The evidence room: data-led
Campaign	vibathon.in, Founders Day, summit seasons	Same grammar, one louder accent (≤ 25%)

HERITAGE, USED WITH CARE

The kolam reference is **structural, not decorative**: the dot grid and the joining rule. We never reproduce traditional kolam patterns as wallpaper, and we never use religious motifs.

01.3

What we value

Five values. They decide how we behave before they decide how we sound.



01

Grounded

We go to districts and campuses, and we work in Tamil and English.

SHOWS UP AS

- Naming the district, the college and the month
- Real Tamil Nadu photography: founders, campuses, labs
- Pages built for a ₹12–15k Android phone on 4G



02

Generous

Founders become mentors. Partners get the credit for what they helped build.

SHOWS UP AS

- Crediting partners and founders by name
- Saying plainly what is free
- The respectful நீங்கள் form in Tamil copy



03

Rigorous

Every figure carries a source or a confidence tag. Corrections are public.

SHOWS UP AS

- A/B/C tag, source and as-at date beside every figure
- Never rounding differently in translation
- Signed partners only; a public corrections log



04

Bold

We set a public goal, Mission 1 Lakh, and report against it every quarter.

SHOWS UP AS

- Short declaratives that end on the outcome
- One red point per composition
- No exclamation marks, no superlatives



05

Tamil-proud & global

Built for Tamil Nadu, connected to the Tamil diaspora and to world markets.

SHOWS UP AS

- Tamil Nadu named first, then the world
- Tamil designed, not translated, in every component
- Brand names kept in Latin script in Tamil text

01.4

Who we speak to

Three groups. Talent is the product, and never the only payer. Payers and partners fund the work. Amplifiers extend reach.

Talent

Four pools, four doors. What we offer, and what they ask first.

STARTNET VIBE

Students

Build something real in college, free to start, in Tamil or English, with a next step for every winner.

THEY ASK "Is this a fee trap?" "Only for Chennai?"

STARTNET RESEARCH

Scholars and faculty

Turn your research into a company you co-own, on standard terms your institution can sign.

THEY ASK "Will my university allow it?" "Who owns the IP?"

STARTNET CONNECT

Professionals and startups

Test your idea and find a co-founder before you leave your job. For startups: customers, capital and pilots.

THEY ASK "Networking without outcomes?"

STARTNET WOMEN

Women founders

From business owner to investable founder: market access first, capital next.

THEY ASK "Only for tech founders?" "Is my business too small?"

Payers and partners

They fund the work, and check the evidence.

Institutions
Founder outcomes you can report, not workshops you have to justify.

GCCs and corporates
Pilots, problem-solving research and AI talent from across Tamil Nadu, in one account.

Government
Measured delivery in every district, feeding StartupTN, iTNT and EDII-TN programmes.

Sponsors and CSR
Verified audiences and reportable outcomes, on one published rate card.

Investors
First look at founders who have climbed a measured ladder, with tagged evidence.

Amplifiers

Media
Facts, images, spokespeople

Diaspora
Ways to mentor, invest or open markets

Job seekers
Roles at StartNet

01.5

Brand architecture and naming

1 MASTERBRAND

StartNet.

Promise and proof:
“Every talent, a founder.”

4 TALENT BRANDS

StartNet Research	StartNet Vibe	StartNet Connect	StartNet Women
Scholar → Founder	Student → Founder	Professional → Founder Startup → Scale	Woman → Founder
StartNet Labs Lab-to-Market Summit	Vibe Academy Vibe Campus **Vibathon** · endorsed	Connect Series Connect Circles StartNet Angels	Women Circles Rise Academy HerCapital

6 SHARED ENGINES

Convene	Learn	Insights	Launch	Capital	Access
Events	Learning	Ledger, data	Incubation	Grants, angels	Markets, pilots

1 PLATFORM

StartNet X SNX — One profile, first event to first funding

NAMING RULES

01 StartNet is one word, capital S and N.
Never Startnet, STARTNET or Start Net.

02 Talent brands are always StartNet + audience.
StartNet Research, Vibe, Connect, Women. Never SN Vibe or StartNetVibe.

03 Programmes are typographic labels, without logos.
Vibe Academy, Connect Circles, Women Circles, StartNet Labs.

04 Vibathon is the only endorsed wordmark.
Always with its line: “a StartNet Vibe programme”.

05 StartNet X in prose; SNX as the app mark.
Engines are never navigation labels.

06 Retired names stay retired.
SNX.One, SNXOne and StartNetVibe are not used.

01.6

Voice and tone

THE RULE UNDER ALL FIVE VALUES

Plain, specific, outcome-first.

WE SAY

“We helped [n] founders raise ₹[x] Cr.” · [tag] · as at [date]

NOT

“We empower the ecosystem.”

Grounded

WE SAY

Name the district, the college, the month.

IN TAMIL

Everyday contemporary Tamil, as an educated Coimbatore or Madurai founder speaks it.

NOT

“Pan-India ecosystem synergy.”

Generous

WE SAY

Credit partners and founders by name. Say what is free.

IN TAMIL

The respectful நீங்கள் form, used consistently.

NOT

Taking credit for founders’ outcomes.

Rigorous

WE SAY

Every figure has a source, an as-at date and an A/B/C tag.

IN TAMIL

The same figures and tags. Never rounded differently in translation.

NOT

“1000s of founders.”

Bold

WE SAY

Short declaratives. End on the outcome.

IN TAMIL

Short sentences. No long Sanskritised compounds.

NOT

Exclamation marks, superlatives.

Tamil-proud & global

WE SAY

Tamil Nadu named first, then the world.

IN TAMIL

Written natively by Tamil editors. Machine translation is a draft only.

NOT

Exotic clichés; Tamil as decoration.

01.7

Writing rules

01 StartNet is one word, capital S and N.
The red full stop belongs to the logo. In running text, StartNet takes no dot.

02 Numerals use Indian grouping.
1,00,000, not 100,000. Write ₹6 Cr and ₹6 கோடி, in Indo-Arabic digits in both languages.

03 Every figure travels with its proof.
Source, A/B/C tag and as-at date, in one unit: [value] founders · [A] · as at [date].

04 Tamil is written natively, not translated.
Tamil editors write it. No letter-spacing and no all-caps styling on Tamil.

05 Calls to action start with a verb.
Join StartNet · Find a programme · Read the Ledger. Tamil CTAs stay under about 18 characters.

06 Tamil Nadu is two words.
Spell out GCC (Global Capability Centre) on first use.

07 No exclamation marks, no superlatives.
Short declaratives that end on the outcome.

08 British English, sentence case.
Programme, organisation, colour. Headlines and buttons in sentence case.

WORDS WE DO NOT USE

~~ecosystem synergy~~	the district, the college, the month
~~empower the ecosystem~~	what happened, to whom
~~1000s of founders~~	[n] founders · [tag] · as at [date]
~~Startnet · STARTNET~~	StartNet
~~SN Vibe · StartNetVibe~~	StartNet Vibe
~~Tamilnadu~~	Tamil Nadu
~~broucher~~	brochure

WORDS WE KEEP

- founder
- talent
- district
- outcome
- Ledger
- verified
- as at
- every talent

01.8

Messaging and boilerplate

DESCRIPTOR

StartNet.

Tamil Nadu’s founder-making network

In formal use, it always travels with the logo.

ONE LINE, FOR BIOS

Every talent,
a founder.

The promise, word for word.

BOILERPLATE · COPY-READY

75 WORDS

StartNet is Tamil Nadu’s founder-making network. Its four brands, StartNet Research, StartNet Vibe, StartNet Connect and StartNet Women, help scholars, students, professionals and women become founders through events, learning, incubation, capital and market access, all run on one platform, StartNet X. StartNet’s goal, Mission 1 Lakh, is to nurture 1,00,000 founders in Tamil Nadu by March 2031, counted in a public, quarterly Founder Ledger. StartNet is based in Salem, Tamil Nadu. Every talent, a founder.

MESSAGING HIERARCHY

Masterbrand Promise and proof	**StartNet.** Every talent, a founder. · Mission 1 Lakh · Founder Ledger StartNet is one word. The red full stop is the logo device, not punctuation in running text.
Talent brand Audience and path	StartNet Vibe: Student → Founder Always StartNet + audience; never SN Vibe or StartNetVibe. One accent colour each.
Programme Offer and next step	Vibe Academy: AI building, product and go-to-market, in Tamil and English Short brand + plain format. “Vibathon, a StartNet Vibe programme”.
Platform Where you act	Continue on StartNet X StartNet X in prose, SNX as the app mark. Engines are not navigation labels.

02
Logo

THE LOCKUP CONSTRUCTION CLEAR SPACE COLOUR VERSIONS BRAND LOCKUPS MONOGRAM CO-BRANDING MISUSE

02.1

The lockup



MASTERBRAND · PRIMARY VERSION

INK + SNX RED ON PAPER

One artwork in three parts. The parts are never separated, or rebuilt from type.

01 **Wordmark.** “StartNet”, one word, capital S and N.
Drawn from Inter at a heavy weight with tightened spacing, outlined as artwork. Never typed live.

02 **The full stop.** A perfect circle in SNX Red.
Heavier than a typed period, so it reads as a mark, not punctuation.

03 **Descriptor.** Optional.
Used only in brand lockups, page 19.

Final outlined vector artwork is produced from the construction on page 16.
[Existing StartNet logo files to be supplied by StartNet to confirm the letterforms · Book 3 open item 1]

02.2

Construction and the full stop



Cap height and x-height
0.728 em and 0.546 em above the baseline in Inter

Baseline
The full stop sits on it, like the foot of every letter

Stem, s
The wordmark's vertical stem, shown on the final “t”

Drawn to the master construction (Book 3 §2.1). The stop is a perfect circle, never an ellipse or a rounded square, and slightly heavier than a typed period so it holds at small sizes.

d

The unit. d is the diameter of the full stop. Every clear space and lockup distance in this chapter is measured in d.

	MASTER	ON SCREEN
Diameter, d	1.2 s	0.20 em
Gap to the “t”	0.6 s (0.5 d)	0.07 em margin
Position	On the baseline	0.01 em overshoot
Tracking	Tightened	−3.5%
Weight	Heavy, outlined	Inter 750

“On screen” is the website's CSS logo. In Inter 750, s measures 0.159 em, so its 0.20 em stop is 1.26 s, and the ink gap to the “t” is about 0.05 em.
[Reconcile with the master files when supplied · open item 1]

02.3

Clear space and minimum size



3d on every side, measured from the outermost ink: the S at the left and top, the full stop at the right. No text, edge or other logo enters it. Three stops of clear space are about the cap height of the S.

88 px

StartNet.

Masterbrand
88 px · 22 mm

132 px

StartNet. Research

Brand lockup
132 px · 32 mm

S.

Below minimum
Use the monogram

RULE	VALUE
Clear space, every lockup	**3d, all sides**
From a page or screen edge	**3d or the margin, if larger**
Minimum, masterbrand	**88 px · 22 mm**
Minimum, brand lockup	**132 px · 32 mm**
Below minimum	**Monogram “S.” or the name as text**
Header on startnet.in	**28 px desktop · 22 px mobile**

02.4

Colour versions



PRIMARY

Ink wordmark, red full stop, on Paper or white. First choice everywhere. The stop is **3.39:1** on Paper, above the 3:1 for graphics.



REVERSED

Paper wordmark, red full stop, on Ink, night surfaces and dark photography. The stop is **4.84:1** on Ink.



MONO INK

Ink wordmark and stop. Single-colour print, embossing, mono partner material, and Vibe or Connect fills.



MONO WHITE

White wordmark and stop. Research, Women or red fills, dark photographs with busy colour, low-grade print.

GROUNDS THAT ARE ALLOWED

Primary on Paper, white and light photography. Reversed on Ink, night surfaces and dark photography.

NEVER COLOUR ON AN ACCENT

On an accent, red or mid-tone photo the red stop disappears. Use mono: the stop keeps its shape and gives up its colour.

BESIDE IMAGERY, NOT OVER IT

Set the logo on a solid field next to the image. Where it must sit on a photograph, use a calm area; busy colour takes Mono White.

02.5

Brand lockups

DAY	**StartNet.** Research	**StartNet.** Vibe	**StartNet.** Connect	**StartNet.** Women	**StartNet.** X
	#4A3AA7 Research	**#E2581F** #9F3605 under 24 px	**#0E8F63** #006F4B under 24 px	**#C2386F** Women	**#EF4444** SNX Red, ExtraBold
NIGHT	**StartNet.** Research	**StartNet.** Vibe	**StartNet.** Connect	**StartNet.** Women	**StartNet.** X
	#9894FF Research-400	**#F37C52** Vibe-400	**#5DB88F** Connect-400	**#F0749E** Women-400	**#EF4444** SNX Red, 4.84:1

SPACING, IN D



The descriptor starts 1.5d after the stop, with nothing between: never a separator, a slash or a second dot. Stacked, for square spaces, it sits under the wordmark, ranged left, 1d below the baseline.

Programmes are labels, not logos

The programme name in Inter SemiBold, followed by the brand accent rule, set under the brand lockup. Only the lockup is a logo.

StartNet. Vibe

Vibe Academy

One endorsed wordmark: Vibathon

Vibathon is the only programme with its own wordmark. Its endorsement line reads “a StartNet Vibe programme”, in Inter Medium, ranged left under the wordmark, 1d below it.

[Vibathon wordmark artwork to be supplied]

02.6

Monogram and app icons



PWA, maskable
512, shown at 47%



Apple touch
180, actual size



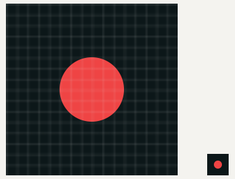
SNX app icon
192 · 512 · 1024



Vibathon icon
192 · 512



Favicon, 32
Shown ×4 and actual size



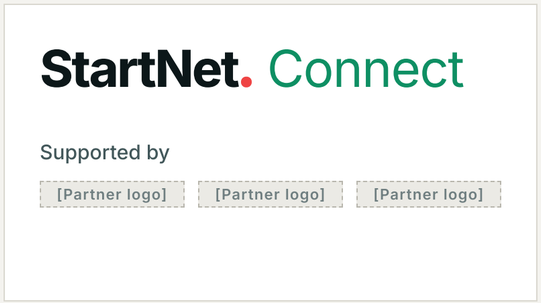
Favicon, 16
Shown ×8 and actual size

At 16 px the S breaks up, so the favicon keeps the stop alone. The dashed ring marks the 80% safe zone of a maskable icon.

ASSET	SIZES
Monogram “S.” White S from the wordmark, red stop, on Ink	Avatars · print
Favicon S. at 32 with a 2 px radius; red dot only at 16	svg · ico 16/32/48
Apple touch icon Monogram on Ink, no transparency	180
PWA Monogram centred in the 80% safe zone	192 · 512
SNX app icon X in Paper, red stop, on Ink	192 · 512 · 1024
Vibathon icon V. in Ink on Vibe; red would vanish (1.01:1)	192 · 512

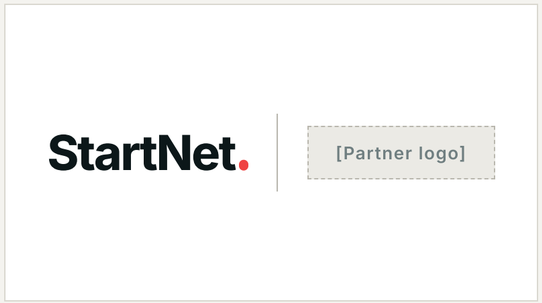
02.7

Co-branding



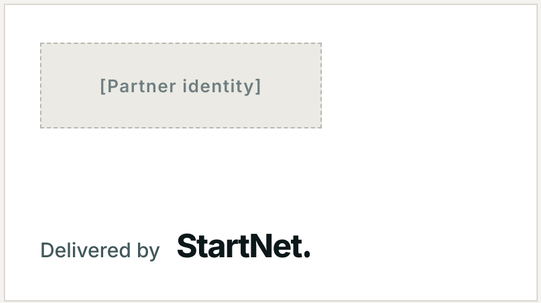
01 StartNet-led

StartNet first and largest. “With” or “Supported by”, then partners in mono at 60–75% of StartNet's cap height.



02 Equal partnership

An institution co-hosts. Equal optical size, a 1 px vertical rule, and 3d from each mark to the rule.



03 Partner-led

The partner's identity and guidelines lead. StartNet appears as “Delivered by” with the mono logo at 88 px or more, or as “Programme partner”.



04 Government co-hosting

Government marks first, in their supplied colours and never recoloured, then “In association with”. The State Emblem only when the department supplies it and approves it in writing.

LOGO WALLS

Mono, equal optical size, one row per tier. No logo larger than 1.2× the median. A static grid on the web; a marquee only with a pause control.



02.8

Misuse



Do not stretch or condense it



Do not rotate it; it is always level



Do not recolour the full stop



Do not use the colour logo on accents



Do not retype it or change its case



Do not add outlines, glows or dots



Do not stack a second descriptor



Do not detach or move the full stop

03
Colour

PRIMARY DERIVATION SECONDARY TERTIARY NEUTRALS BRAND FAMILY FUNCTIONAL TONAL RAMPS GRADIENTS PROPORTION

03.1

Primary colour: *SNX Red*

PRIMARY · THE FULL STOP

SNX Red

#EF4444

HEX	**#EF4444**
RGB	**239 · 68 · 68**
CMYK (screen conversion)	**0 · 72 · 72 · 6**
HSL · OKLCH	**0° 84% 60% · 0.637 0.208 25.3°**
Pantone	**Match on press proof**

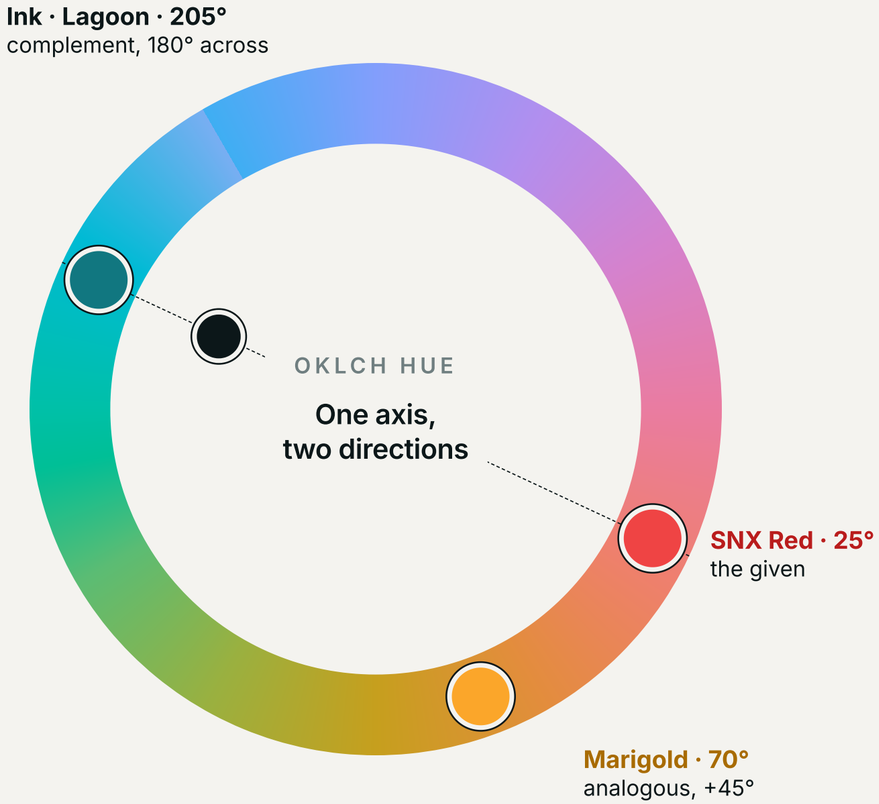
WORKING STEPS OF THE SAME RED

Button	Text on paper	Text on ink
Red 600 #DC2626 Fills with white text, 4.83:1.	**Red 700 #B91C1C** Red words at body size, 5.83:1.	**Red 400 #F87171** Small red on dark, 6.59:1.

The full stop, one accent per surface and the main action. SNX Red clears 4.84:1 on Ink; on Paper (3.39:1) it is for large type and graphics.

03.2

How the palette is derived



01 **Secondary: take the complement to near-black.**

Ink #0C1719 sits 180° across the wheel at lightness 0.20. It reads as black, yet its blue-green bias makes the red look warmer and brighter beside it.

02 **Tertiary, cool: lift the same complement.**

Lagoon #117780 is Ink's lighter sibling (lightness 0.52), so the cool tertiary is part of the same family rather than a new hue.

03 **Tertiary, warm: step 45° toward yellow.**

Marigold #FBA62A is the red's analogous neighbour at high lightness: warm and celebratory, the colour of a marigold garland.

CONSIDERED AND REJECTED

Blue-violet, 265°. Too close to Research and the data blue.

Rose, 0°. Reads as Women and muddies the red.

Green, 145°. Collides with Connect and "success".

03.3

Secondary palette

StartNet.

StartNet.

Ink

SECONDARY · TYPE AND DARK GROUNDS

HEX · RGB	**#0C1719 · 12 · 23 · 25**
CMYK (screen) · OKLCH	**52 · 8 · 0 · 90 · 0.195 0.016 210°**
On Paper	**16.41:1 · all text**

Every word on paper, the header and footer band, covers, chapter dividers and evidence rooms. The same ink as startnet.in.

Paper

SECONDARY · THE GROUND

HEX · RGB	**#F4F3EF · 244 · 243 · 239**
CMYK (screen) · OKLCH	**0 · 0 · 2 · 4 · 0.964 0.005 95°**
In print	**Unprinted uncoated stock**

Warm, not white. The default page and sheet. On uncoated stock, leave it unprinted rather than laying down a tint.

Slate #2C3E41 — raised dark panels

Graphite #42575A — 6.90:1 text

Bone #EBEAE5 — alternate ground

Card #FBFAF7 — cards on paper

03.4

Tertiary palette

TERTIARY · WARM

Marigold

ON INK · 9.19:1

Highlights, campaign moments, the second data series

HEX · RGB	**#FBA62A · 251 · 166 · 42**
OKLCH	**0.791 0.160 70°**
Text on paper	**Use Marigold 800 #7E4F04 (6.29:1)**

Up to 5% of a layout. Never as text on paper (1.79:1).

Never on StartNet Vibe material, where its orange accent leads.

TERTIARY · COOL

Lagoon

ON PAPER · 4.76:1

Links in long reads, cool data series, diagrams

HEX · RGB	**#117780 · 17 · 119 · 128**
OKLCH	**0.521 0.085 205°**
On ink	**Use Lagoon 300 #88C7CE (9.64:1)**

Up to 5% of a layout. Passes AA as text on paper.

Never on StartNet Connect material, where its green accent leads.

03.5

Neutrals and grounds

White

#FFFFFF
Product surfaces, forms

Card

#FBFAF7
Cards on Paper

Paper

#F4F3EF
Default ground

Bone

#EBEAE5
Alternate ground

Hairline

#DAD8D0
Rules and dividers

TEXT COLOUR	ON PAPER
Ink #0C1719 · headings, body	**16.41:1**
Graphite #42575A · secondary text	**6.90:1**
Ink 500 #5E7377 · captions, dates	**4.51:1**
Ink 400 #82979A · disabled, axes	UI only

01 Paper is the page; White is for things you fill in. A form on Paper sits on a White card.

02 Alternate Paper and Bone so a spread or a long page reads as separate sections.

03 Ink 500 is the lightest colour allowed for words. Lighter greys are lines and UI only.

03.6

Brand family accents

Each talent brand is Ink + the red full stop + its own accent. Values are unchanged from Book 3; only the masterbrand red moves to SNX Red.

StartNet. Research

Research

SCHOLAR → FOUNDER

Base	**#4A3AA7**
On ink	**#9894FF**

StartNet. Vibe

Vibe

STUDENT → FOUNDER

Base · small text	**#E2581F · #9F3605**
On ink	**#F37C52**

StartNet. Connect

Connect

PROFESSIONAL → FOUNDER

Base · small text	**#0E8F63 · #006F4B**
On ink	**#5DB88F**

StartNet. Women

Women

WOMAN → FOUNDER

Base	**#C2386F**
On ink	**#F0749E**

On an accent fill the logo goes mono: the red full stop measures under 2:1 against every accent and would disappear.

03.7

Functional palette

✓ Success	**#006F4B** on #EFF9F3 · saved, approved, complete
⚠ Warning	**#7A4700** text · #EDA100 icon · closing soon, check this
ⓘ Error	**#B91C1C** on #FEF2F2 · always with icon and the word "Error"
ⓘ Information	**#145CAE** text · Ledger Blue #2A78D6 · data and info only

A · Verified **B · Claimed** **C · Estimate**

Confidence tags on every figure work without colour: solid, outline, dashed.

01 Functional colour lives in product, forms, dashboards and data. Never in marketing layouts or near the logo.

02 Error shares the brand's red hue, so it always carries an icon, the word "Error" and a 2 px left rule. Never fill a whole form red.

03 Marigold and Lagoon never signal status. Warning stays amber with its icon so the two never read as the same signal.

04 Every state pairs colour with an icon and a word. Colour alone is not an accessible state.

03.8

Tonal ramps

SNX RED · PRIMARY



50	100	200	300	400	500 base	600	700	800	900
#FEF2F2	#FEE2E2	#FECACA	#FCA5A5	#F87171	#EF4444	#DC2626	#B91C1C	#991B1B	#7F1D1D

INK · SECONDARY



50	100	200	300	400	500	600	700	800	900 base
#F4F7F8	#E8EEEF	#CFDADC	#ABBBBE	#82979A	#5E7377	#42575A	#2C3E41	#1B292C	#0C1719

MARIGOLD · TERTIARY WARM



50	100	200	300	400	500 base	600	700	800	900
#FFF5EA	#FFEBD5	#FEDAB2	#FFC580	#FEB75F	#FBA62A	#D98B09	#A86B02	#7E4F04	#593808

LAGOON · TERTIARY COOL



50	100	200	300	400	500 base	600	700	800	900
#EEF9FB	#D9F0F3	#B6E1E6	#88C7CE	#4FA0A9	#117780	#046169	#024C52	#00383D	#012528

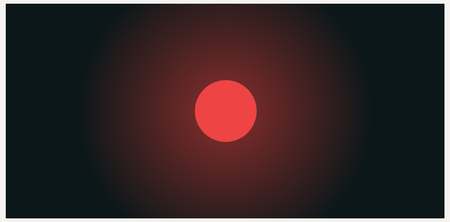
03.9

Gradients and texture



Ember on Ink

The signature. Long ink hold, red arriving in the last third. Covers and stage backdrops.



Halo

A glow centred on a full stop. The only permitted glow, and only on ink.



Nightfall

Ink through its own ramp. Depth on dark grounds where a flat field feels heavy.



Pulli texture

The dot grid at 6–14% Paper on ink. The brand's only pattern.

Paper warm

Barely there. Gives a light page a direction of light without becoming a colour.

FUSION LADDER: RED MIXED INTO INK, IN OKLAB



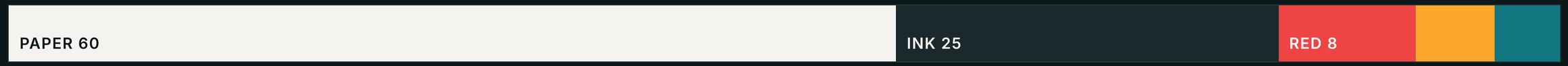
For heat scales and stacked data that need more than two steps. Mixing in OKLab keeps the middle steps from going muddy.

- No gradient behind body copy. Text sets on a flat field.
- No red overlays, tints or gradients on photographs.
- No gradient inside the logo. The full stop is always flat red.

03.10

Proportion and contrast

A working ratio, not a law: about 60 parts Paper, 25 Ink, up to 8 Red, up to 5 tertiary and the brand accent only on its own brand. Red earns its force from scarcity: one full stop, one action, one number per surface.



PAIR	RATIO	CLEARED FOR
Ink on Paper / Paper on Ink	**16.41:1**	All text
Marigold on Ink	**9.19:1**	All text
Red 400 on Ink	**6.59:1**	All text
Red 700 on Paper	**5.83:1**	All text
SNX Red on Ink	**4.84:1**	All text
White on Red 600	**4.83:1**	Buttons, all text
SNX Red on Paper	**3.39:1**	Large type, graphics
Marigold on Paper	**1.79:1**	**Fails · decoration only**

01 WCAG 2.2 AA is the floor: 4.5:1 for text, 3:1 for large text (24 px, or 19 px bold) and interface parts.

02 SNX Red on Ink passes for all text, so on dark grounds the red can be words. On Paper it is a mark, a rule or a big number; red words use Red 700.

03 Every ratio is measured against the brand grounds only. A partner's ground is checked separately before the mark goes on it.

04

Type and *element*

TYPE PAIRING TAMIL TYPE SCALE THE FULL STOP PULLI GRID ICONS PHOTOGRAPHY LAYOUT

04.1

Inter and Instrument Serif

PRIMARY · EVERY WORD

Aa

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
0123456789 ₹ → · , . ? !

Inter. Neutral, so the content and the full stop carry the voice. A variable family from 100 to 900, with wide Latin, Greek and Cyrillic coverage.

ACCENT · ONE WORD

Aa

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

Instrument Serif Italic. One accent word in an English headline. Never in Tamil, never in body text, never twice in one title.

ROLE	SPECIMEN	SETTING
Headlines	Every talent	Inter 400–500 tracking −3% to −4.5%
Accent word	*founder*	Instrument Serif Italic one English word
Section heads	Section head	Inter 500 tracking −2%
Body	Body text sets at 1.5.	Inter 400 leading 1.5
Labels	LABEL ● Dot label	600 caps, +18% in print dot labels on the web
Figures	1,00,000	tabular, lining Indian grouping

HEAVIER OPTION

Inter Display 600–700 (Book 3) for campaign and print display only. The website runs 400–500.

LICENCE AND LOGO

Both fonts are SIL OFL 1.1. The logo is drawn artwork, never retyped from either.

04.2

Tamil typography

THE BRAND LINE IN TAMIL

ANEK TAMIL 600 · 78 PX · LEADING 1.28

ஒவ்வொரு திறமையும்
ஒரு நிறுவனர்.

[draft — for native editor review] · “Every talent, a founder.”

Noto Sans Tamil

TEXT AND UI · 400 AND 600

அ ஆ இ ஈ உ ஊ எ ஏ ஐ
க ச ட த ப ற · கி கீ கு கூ

Android ships Noto as its Tamil system font, so the fallback matches before the web font arrives. Weighted score 4.7 of 5, first of five candidates.

Anek Tamil

DISPLAY · 28 PX AND ABOVE

அ ஆ இ ஈ உ ஊ எ ஏ ஐ
க ச ட த ப ற · கி கீ கு கூ

Its width axis (75–125) keeps a long Tamil headline to two lines without dropping the size. If it misses the first render, Noto stands in.

EIGHT RULES FOR TAMIL

01 Body one step up, display one step down.
Body ×1.06 with about 16% more leading; display ×0.82–0.9, as headlines run 30–40% longer.

02 No letter-spacing.
Tracking breaks conjuncts. All tracking resets to 0 in Tamil.

03 No all-caps styling.
No case in Tamil. Eyebrows: 14 px, weight 600, no transform.

04 Never split inside a syllable.
Animate by word or line; never word-break: break-all.

05 Indian digit grouping, no Tamil numerals.
1,00,000 in both languages. Write ₹6 கோடி; never க, ஒ in UI or data.

06 Brand names stay Latin.
“StartNet X” stays in Inter inside Tamil text, so it looks the same in both.

07 Weights 400 and 600.
Avoid 300 and below: hairline Tamil strokes break up on low-DPI screens.

08 Set the lang attributes.
lang="ta" on Tamil pages and lang="en" on English spans inside them.

04.3

Type scale and rules

01 Line length 60–72 characters.
Set English body to 68ch. Cap Tamil at 36 em, since its ch unit misleads.

02 Tabular figures in data.
Every table, counter, date column and price, so figures never jitter.

03 Sentence case.
Headlines, buttons and labels. Capitals only for print labels.

04 Ranged left, ragged right.
No justified text, no centred paragraphs.

05 Two sizes per element.
A card, tile or slide block takes one head size and one text size.

STYLE · SLIDE	SPECIMEN AT SLIDE SIZE	WEB TOKEN · TAMIL
Display 150 px · 500 · −4.5%	founder	**display-2xl 40→88** Tamil ×0.82 · 1.25
Page title 84 px · 500 · −3.5%	Every talent	**h1 32→56** Tamil ×0.88 · 1.3
Section head 40 px · 500 · −2%	One red point per composition	**h2 26→40** Tamil ×0.9 · 1.35
Lead 34 px · 400 · 1.42	Calm page, decisive point.	**body-lg 18→20** Tamil ×1.06 · 1.8
Body 26 px · 400 · 1.5	Hierarchy comes from type size, weight and space, not colour. Ink and Paper do the work.	**body 16→17** Tamil ×1.06 · 1.8
Caption 22 px · 400 · 1.5	StartNet Vibe at TNGSS 2025, Coimbatore	**caption 13** Tamil ×1.08, min 14
Label 19 px · 600 · +18%	OUR BRANDS ● Our brands	**eyebrow 12→13** Tamil 14 px, no caps

Web sizes interpolate from 360 to 1440 px viewports (rem + vw), so text still scales with browser zoom.

04.4

The full stop system

One red point per composition. If two things are red, neither is the point.

01 Always a true circle.
Never stretched, outlined, shaded or glowing.

02 Red or mono only.
SNX Red, or mono on accent fills and in one-colour print.

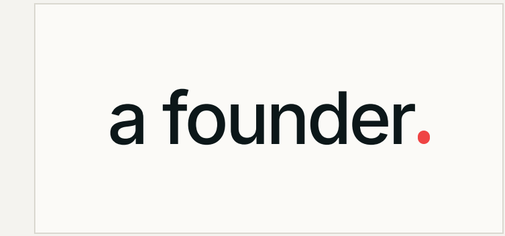
03 Never two red points.
Other emphasis takes Ink or the brand accent.

04 Never inside the logo's clear space.
Keep 3d clear around any lock-up.

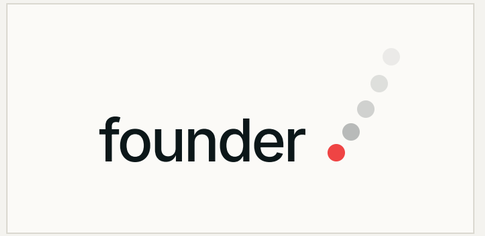
05 Only the full stop moves.
It lands once per session; letters stay still.



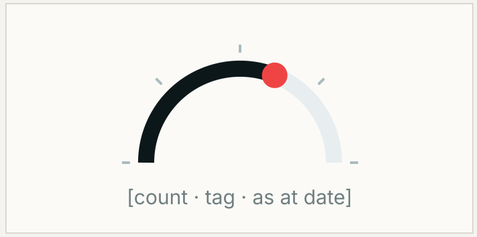
Mark
The logo's full stop, 0.2 em



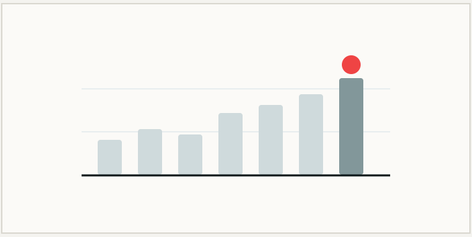
Headline
Ends a statement, not a hope



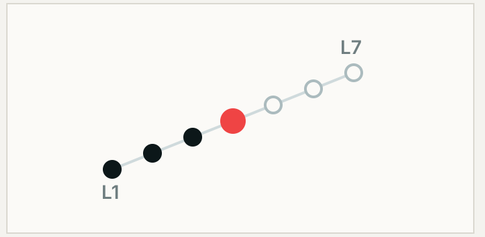
Landing
Plays once per session, after load



Meter
The current verified count, Mission 1 Lakh



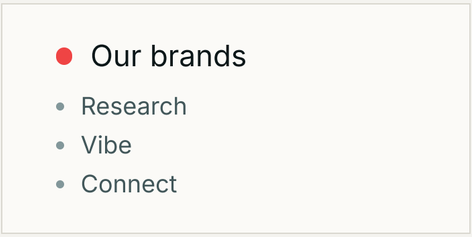
Ledger chart
Grey data; the current value is the point



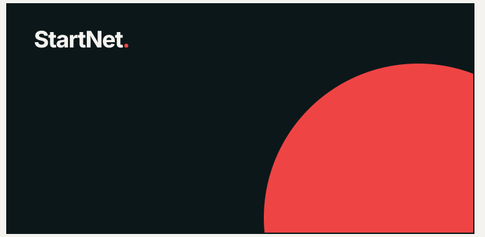
Ladder L1–L7
The current level is filled red



Seal
One red dot on the certificate's pulli border



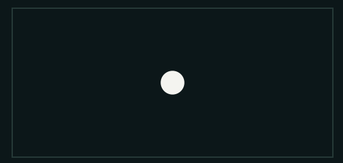
Bullet and dot label
Labels lead with the point; bullets stay grey



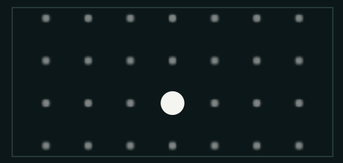
Field crop
Page scale, cropped by an edge

04.5

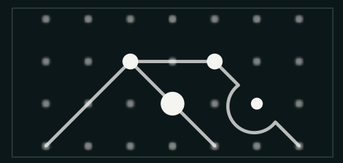
Pulli grid and *network*



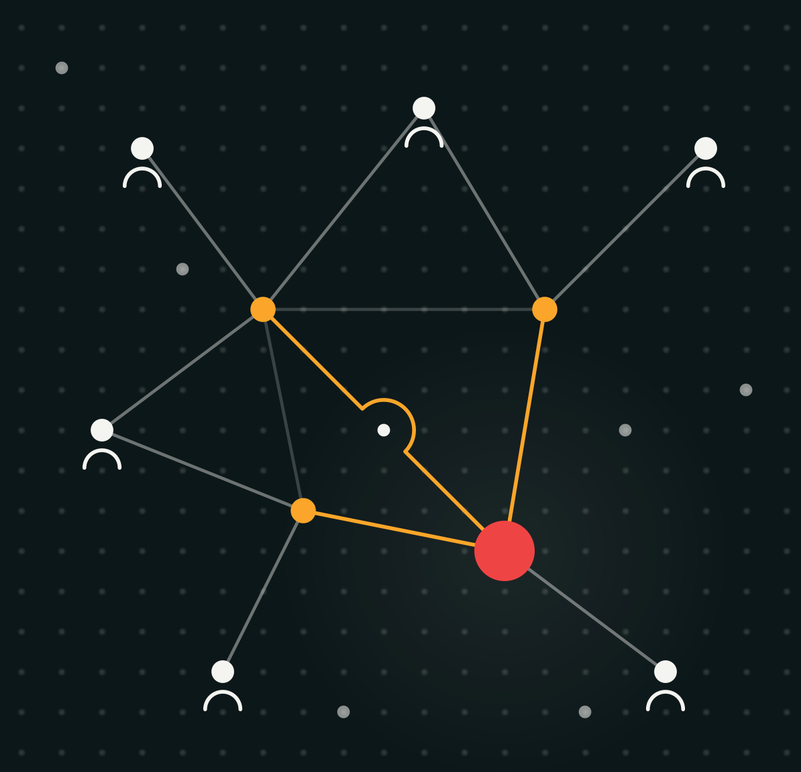
01 Dot
One talent



02 Grid
The pulli: a community, a district



03 Network
Lines join dots or loop around them



04 Full stop
The network resolves into one decisive point: a founder, an outcome

CONSTRUCTION

Lattice	Square dot grid: 4 px at icon size, 8–16 px at spot and hero
Lines	Join dots or loop around them, the kolam rule. Never freehand
Colour	Flat fills: Ink, Paper, one accent and the red point
Stroke	2 px at 24 px, rising to 8 px at 96 px; round caps
People	A dot head and an arc body. Never a stand-in for a real founder

USES

Section dividers · Empty states · The 404 page · Ladder explorer · Vibathon season art · Certificate borders

HERITAGE, USED WITH CARE

The kolam reference is structural: the dot grid and the joining rule. No traditional kolam patterns as wallpaper, and no religious motifs. A Tamil cultural adviser signs off the motif library: [adviser to be appointed by StartNet].

04.6

Iconography

LAYER 1 · LUCIDE UI ICONS



Grid	24 px box, 2 px padding
Stroke	2 px, round caps and joins
Colour	currentColor: Ink, or Ink 700 for secondary
Licence	ISC; imported one icon at a time

LAYER 2 · PICTOGRAM SIZES

Sizes	24 px UI · 48 px cards · 96 px spot
Lattice	4 px dots inside the 24 px box
Point	Ink at rest. Red or the accent from 32 px, active state only

LAYER 2 · STARTNET PICTOGRAMS, DRAWN ON THE PULLI GRID



Convene
Three dots facing a fourth



Learn
A dot above an open book



Insights
The tallest bar ends in a dot



Launch ACTIVE
Steps up to the final dot



Vibe
A pulse that ends in a dot



Connect
Two clusters and a bridge



Women
A rising arc to a summit dot



StartNet X
A dot where strokes cross

Shown at 96 px. Also in the set: Capital, Access, Research and Ladder L1–L7.

01 Pair every icon with a label. Icon-only buttons carry an aria-label.

02 Stroke only. Never mixed with filled styles; the point is the one fill.

03 No gradients, shadows or 3-D. No emoji in the interface.

04 Accents stay home. A brand's accent only on its own pages.

04.7

Photography



SaaS Connect 2025
PSG Convention Centre, Coimbatore



Vibathon 2025
K.S.R. College of Engineering, Tiruchengode

GRADE Brand surfaces: near-monochrome with a warm paper tint, as live on startnet.in. No red overlays or tints.



Paper-ink · brand surfaces
StartNet event, February 2024

[Founder portrait in full colour, to be supplied by StartNet]

Full colour · own story
A founder portrait in their own story



Duotone · Ink + one accent
Campaign graphics only (here Vibe).
StartNet Vibe at TNGSS 2025, Coimbatore

PRINCIPLES

01 Real Tamil Nadu.
Workshops, campuses, labs and districts, as they are.

02 Doing, not posing.
Hands on the work, a pitch mid-sentence, a circle in discussion.

03 Proof in the caption.
Name, organisation, place and date. Evidence is never a composite.

04 Representation by design.
Gender, district, age, disability, language and type of institution.

05 Accurate skin tones.
No lightening, "fairness" grading or reshaping.

DO
A Tier-2 college hall at a build night. Women founders leading and building.

DON'T
Stock towers and handshakes. Uncaptioned crowds. Red overlays or tints.

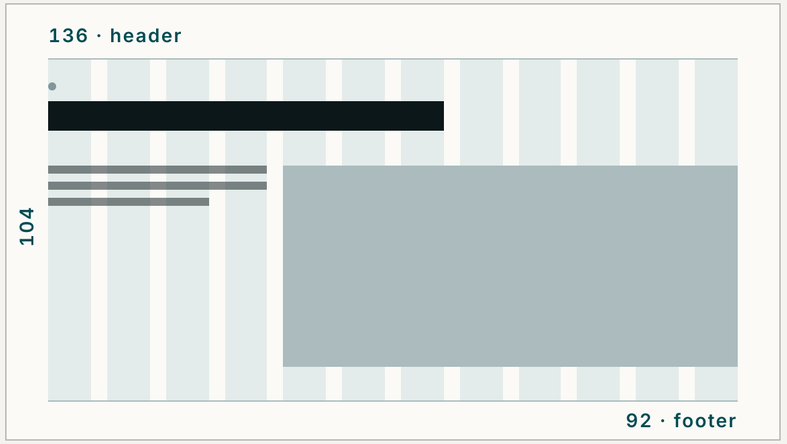
AI IMAGERY

Never generated: real or realistic people, campuses, events or places, anything used as evidence, and Tamil cultural or religious motifs.

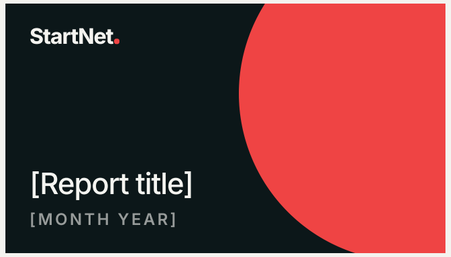
Allowed with a label: abstract textures and concept illustrations, captioned "AI-assisted illustration", directed by a named designer and logged.

04.8

Layout and cover architecture

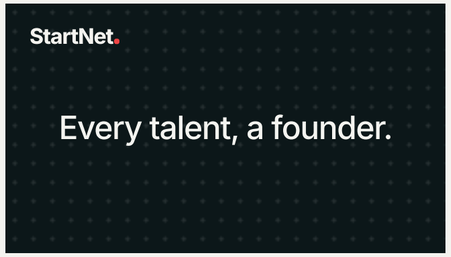


Slide	1920 × 1080: 12 columns of 106 px, 40 px gutters, 104 px margins
Web	12 columns from 1024 px, 24–32 px gutters, 1280 px container; 4 columns on phones
Spacing	4-point: 4 · 8 · 12 · 16 · 24 · 32 · 48 · 64 · 96 · 128
Baseline	8 px; blocks and leading snap to it



A · Field crop

Ink ground, a giant full stop cropped by an edge, type in the clean half. Reports, campaigns.



B · Night and pulli grid

A centred, quiet statement on the dot grid. Stage backdrops, chapter openers.



C · Paper and corner full stop

Paper ground, the point in a corner. Proposals, letters.

01 One cover architecture per piece.
Choose A, B or C and hold it through the document; never combine two.

02 Logo top-left on documents.
Covers, letters, proposals and reports, at the margin, outside any full stop.

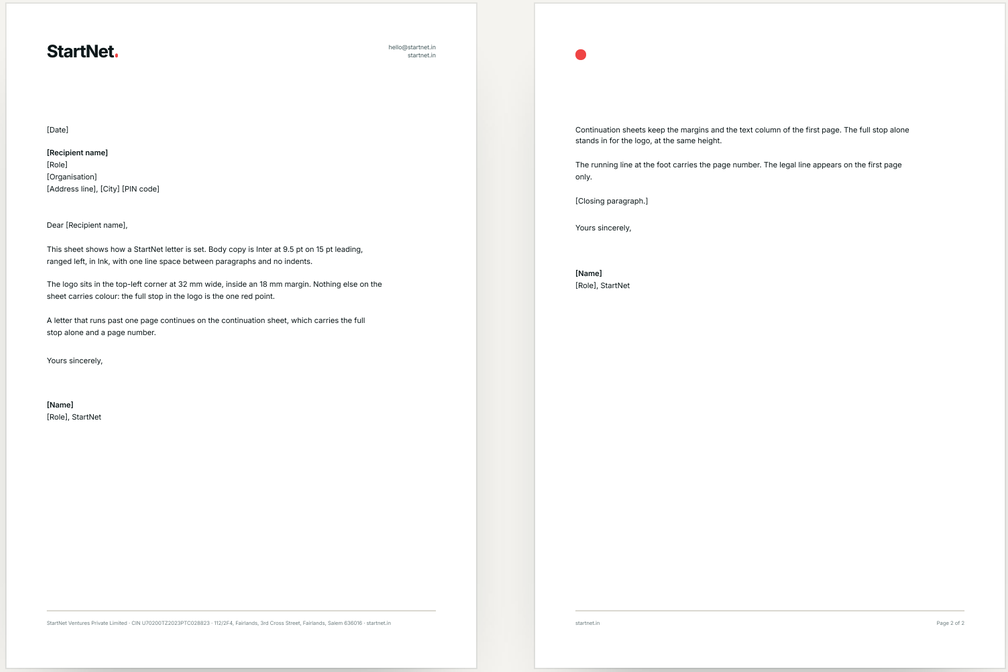
03 Type never sits on the full stop.
The circle is a shape, not a panel. Headlines stay in the clean half.

05 Applications

STATIONERY CARD AND BADGE EVENT SIGNAGE DECK SOCIAL CERTIFICATES MERCHANDISE WEBSITE AND EMAIL

05.1

Stationery



Letterhead and continuation sheet · A4

Footer: StartNet Ventures Private Limited · CIN U70200TZ2023PTC028823
112/2F4, Fairlands, 3rd Cross Street, Fairlands, Salem 636016 · startnet.in

SPECIFICATION	VALUE
Margin, all sides	**18 mm**
Logo width	**32 mm**
Body type	**Inter 9.5 / 15 pt**
Stock	**120 gsm uncoated**
Inks	**2 spot, or CMYK**
Pantone references	[to be confirmed after proofing, Book 3 §3.2]

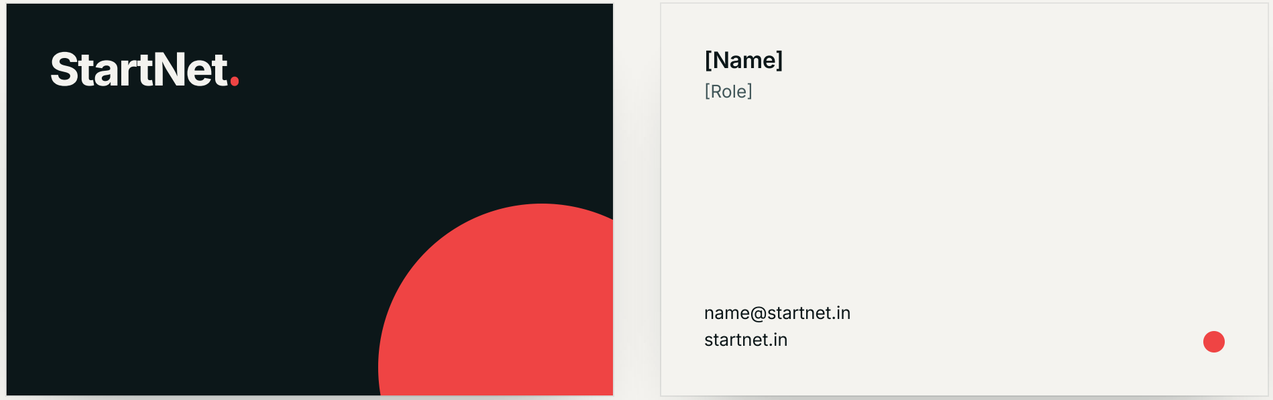


Envelope · DL

220 × 110 mm on Ink, with a cropped full stop and the return address in Paper.

05.2

Business card and event badge



Business card · 85 × 55 mm
Front on Ink, back on Paper · 400 gsm uncoated, square corners

CARD RULES

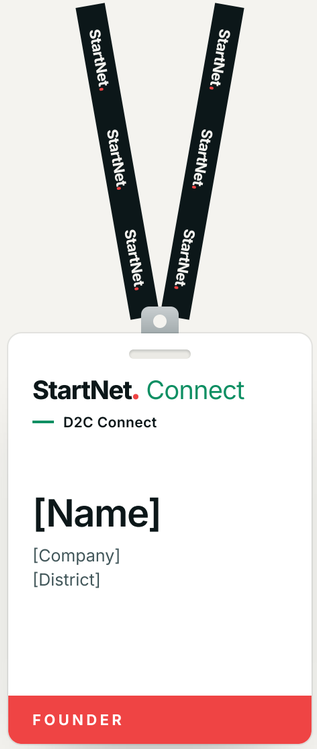
The front is the mark only: the logo and one cropped full stop on Ink.

The back is Paper, so details read. One 3 mm full stop, in the corner.

BADGE RULES

The name is 16 pt or larger, readable at 1.5 m. Company and district below.

The role is a word on a 15 mm band, never a colour alone.



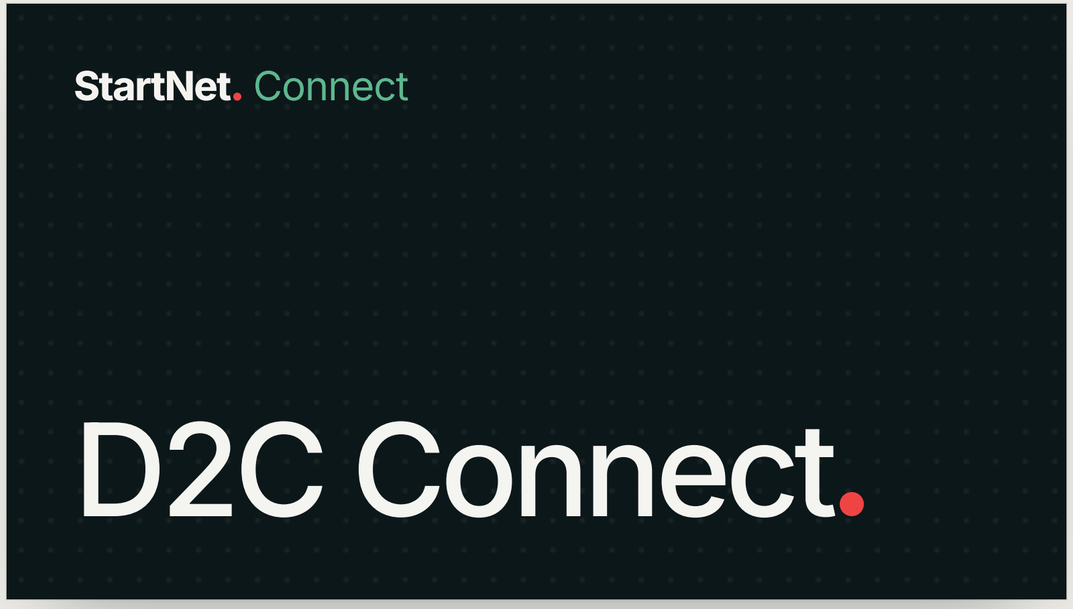
Event badge · A6
Ink lanyard, Paper wordmark

ROLE BANDS

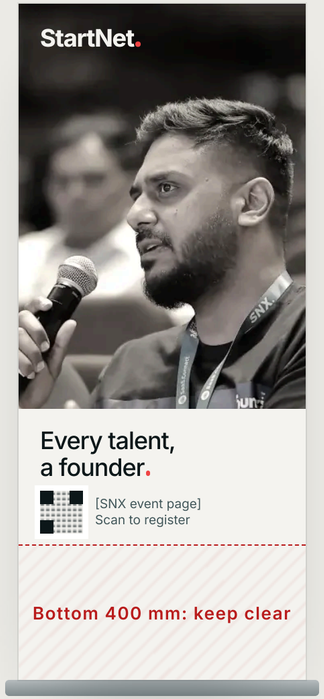
FOUNDER	**Founder** SNX Red
MENTOR	**Mentor** Ink on Paper
PARTNER	**Partner** Neutral-400
MEDIA	**Media** Ledger Blue
NO PHOTOS	**Opt-out lanyard** Marigold-300, announced at registration

05.3

Event signage



Stage backdrop · 16:9, with a lower-third strip
Evergreen: no dates or city. The strip carries them, so photos stay reusable.



Roll-up standee
850 × 2000 mm
60% photo, 40% Paper



Wayfinding board · Paper, Ink
Tamil above English at the same weight

LARGE FORMAT	RULE
Cap height	≈ 25 mm per 3 m
QR code	≥ 25 mm, 4-module quiet zone
Arrows	Lucide, 2× cap height
Finish	Matte only

05.4

Deck template



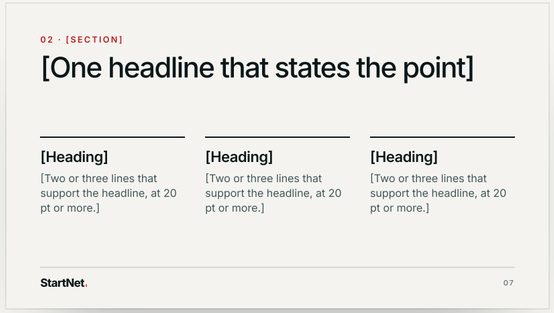
Cover

Ink, field-crop full stop, logo top left.



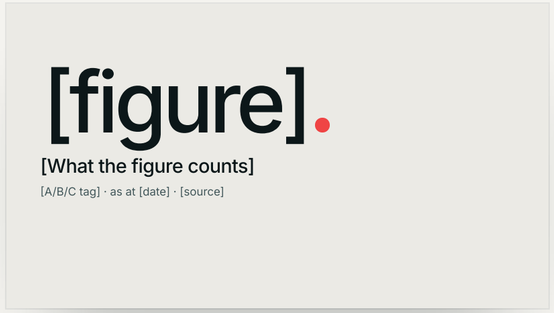
Section divider

Number in red, one word. The same every time.



Content

Paper, three columns with a rule and a folio.



Single figure

Bone, one figure with its tag, date and source.

Built at 1920 × 1080.
Titles 48 pt or larger on screen, body 20 pt or larger. Nothing smaller reaches the back of a room.

Two grounds per deck.
Ink for covers and dividers, Paper for content. Bone is a tint of Paper, kept for a single figure.

One idea per slide.
If a slide needs a second headline, it is two slides.

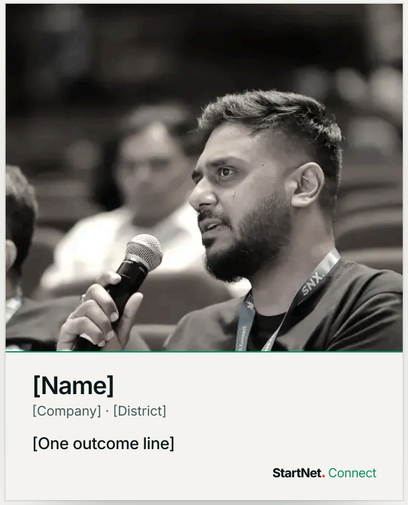
Every figure carries its tag.
A/B/C tag, as-at date and source sit with the number, not in a footnote.

05.5

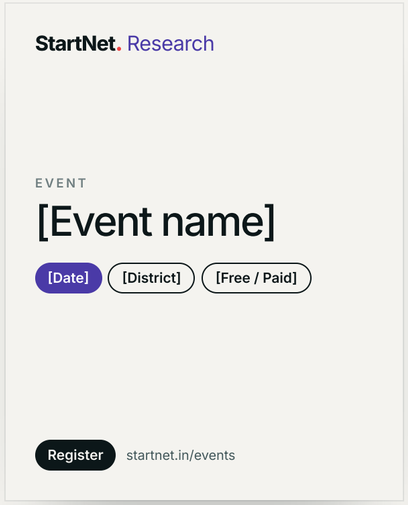
Social posts



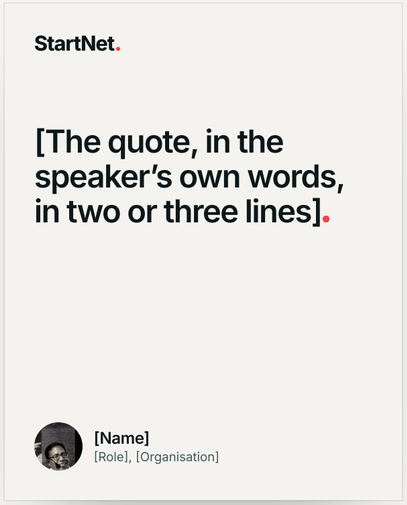
Stat post
Night, one figure, its tag.



Founder story
Real photo, Paper panel.



Event announce
Accent on the date chip only.



Quote card
Paper; the full stop ends the quote.

FORMATS

1080 × 1350	Feed master, 4:5
1080 × 1080	Square feed
1080 × 1920	Story; type inside the 1080 × 1420 safe area
1200 × 630	Link card
1584 × 396	Profile banner

Every format is cut from the 4:5 master, so type and the tag move together.

One language per post.
Separate English and Tamil posts; if bilingual, Tamil first.

Alt text, always.
Text in the image is repeated in the caption.

Type at 4% or more
of the canvas height: 54 px on a 1350 px post.

The logo once.
One lock-up per post, never a watermark.

05.6

Certificates



Certificate · A4 landscape
The pulli-grid frame closes on one red dot: the full stop as a seal.

ELEMENT	SPECIFICATION
Format	**A4 landscape · PDF/A for digital**
Stock	**Uncoated, 250 gsm or more**
Lock-up	**Brand lock-up, top left**
Recipient	**Inter 600, centred; Tamil name below**
Details	**Programme, cohort, level L1–L7, dates**
Border	**Pulli grid in Neutral, one red dot**
Signatures	**Real, named and titled only**
Verification	**Slashed-zero ID, QR to SNX**
Partners	**Signed co-delivery partners only**
Accessibility	**Tagged PDF, EN and Tamil tags, real text**

Signatories and the verification URL pattern are open items for StartNet and SNX product (Book 3, Appendix B).

05.7

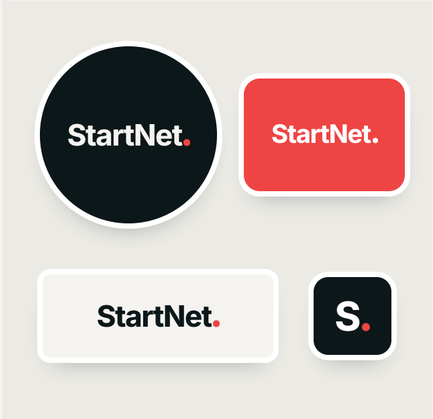
Merchandise



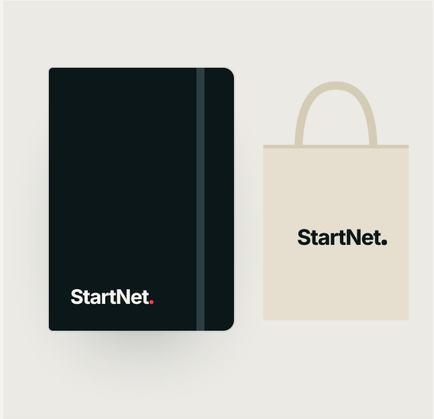
Vibathon tees
Ink, Paper wordmark, the red full stop on the left sleeve. Volunteers wear Vibe with an Ink wordmark.



StartNet hoodie and tee
Ink garment, Paper logo, 90 mm wide on the chest. No back print.



Stickers
Ink circle, Paper rectangle, the “S.” below 22 mm. On red, the logo is mono white only.



Notebook and tote
A5 notebook in Ink. Natural canvas tote, one-colour Ink mark.



Bottle
Ink steel, 600 ml. The “S.” monogram at 40 mm, centred.

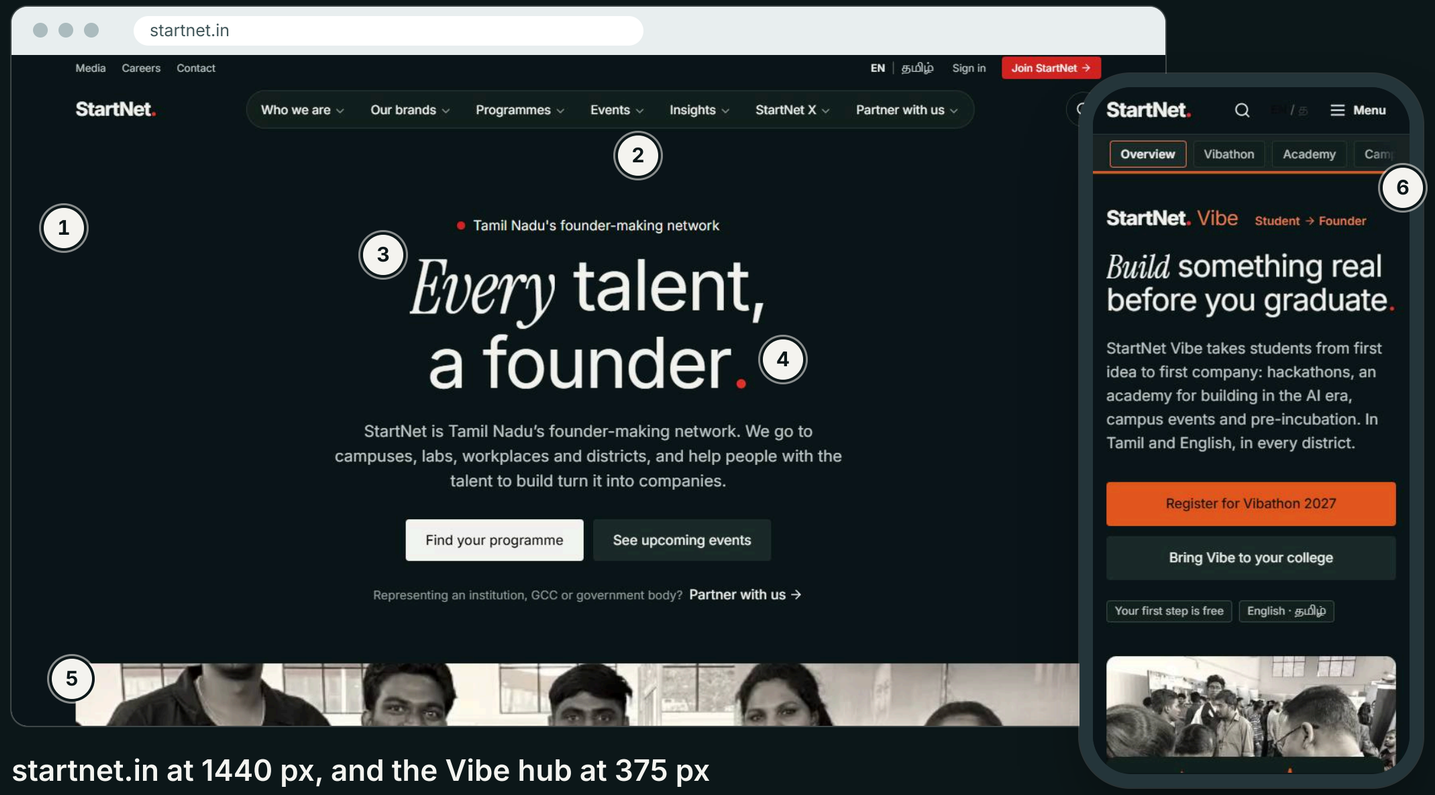
Single colour first.
Every item must work in one colour, Paper on Ink or Ink on canvas, before a two-colour version is quoted.

Below 22 mm, the monogram.
Embroidery, etching and pad print close up small type. Under 22 mm, use the “S.” in place of the wordmark.

No mascots, no novelty.
No illustrated full stop, no slogan merchandise. The range is short on purpose.

05.8

Website and email



startnet.in at 1440 px, and the Vibe hub at 375 px

1. **Ink band.** The header and hero sit on Ink.
2. **Pill navigation,** like the buttons and chips.
3. **One serif word** in Instrument Serif Italic.
4. **Red stays small:** Join StartNet and the full stops.
5. **Paper sheets** rise over the band with rounded tops.
6. **Brand hubs add one accent:** the sub-nav rule and the brand button.

EMAIL SIGNATURE

[Message text]

[Name]
[Role] · StartNet
name@startnet.in · startnet.in

StartNet.

Live text in the mail client's sans. The logo is the only image, 88 px wide. No banners, quotes or social icons.

00.3

Governance and sign-off

DECISION	WHO DECIDES (PROPOSED)	WHEN
Logo, colour, type	Brand owner, in writing	Not delegated
New application or template	Brand review, at concept	Before design
Co-branding	Brand owner and legal	Signed agreement first
Signage and large print runs	Brand review, on proof	Before print
Decks from the masters	Nobody: go ahead	—

OPEN ITEMS FOR THE NEXT EDITION

01 **Sign off SNX Red #EF4444**, then move startnet.in's red tokens to it.

02 Logo vector files, to confirm letterforms and outline the artwork.

03 Pantone and press CMYK from a print partner's press proof.

04 Tamil specimen test, Tamil tagline and a cultural adviser.

APPROVAL

Approved by — Name

Role — Title

Date — DD / MM / YYYY

Asset library	**startnet.in/media**
Brand and media	**press@startnet.in**
Typefaces	**Inter · Instrument Serif**
Tamil typefaces	**Noto Sans Tamil · Anek Tamil**

© StartNet Ventures Private Limited, Salem. Confidential: for StartNet work only.

StartNet.

Every talent, a *founder*.